NON-WSQ COURSE | DIGITAL IMAGE PRODUCTION

Adobe Lightroom Masterclass

From capture to delivery: make every pixel intentional, traceable, and fit for purpose.

Course Code: C200
Trainer: Dr. Alfred Ang
Version v1.0 | 30 September 2026



Tertiary Infotech Academy Pte Ltd | UEN 201200696W

SECTION 00

Course Administration

Welcome | expectations | resources

Observe the image. State the intent. Make a controlled change. Verify the result.

About the Trainer



General Trainer

Trainer profile template

NAME _____

TITLE / DESIGNATION _____

QUALIFICATIONS _____

AREAS OF EXPERTISE _____

TRAINING EXPERIENCE _____

CONTACT _____

About the Trainer



Dr. Alfred Ang

Principal Trainer | Tertiary Infotech Academy

ROLE	Principal Trainer and learning architect
SPECIALISM	Digital imaging, creative technology, AI and workflow design
APPROACH	Evidence-led, highly visual and production focused
FACILITATION	Demonstration, deliberate practice and stakeholder critique
ORGANISATION	Tertiary Infotech Academy Pte Ltd
CONTACT	enquiry@tertiaryinfotech.com

Let’s Know Each Other

1. **Your name and role**
2. The photographs you edit or want to edit
3. Your current Lightroom experience
4. One quality or workflow problem you want to solve

Ground Rules

1

PROTECT ORIGINALS

Work non-destructively and keep source files intact.

2

EDIT WITH INTENT

State the visual problem before moving a control.

3

CHECK AT 100%

Inspect edges, texture, artefacts, and masks.

4

RESPECT RIGHTS

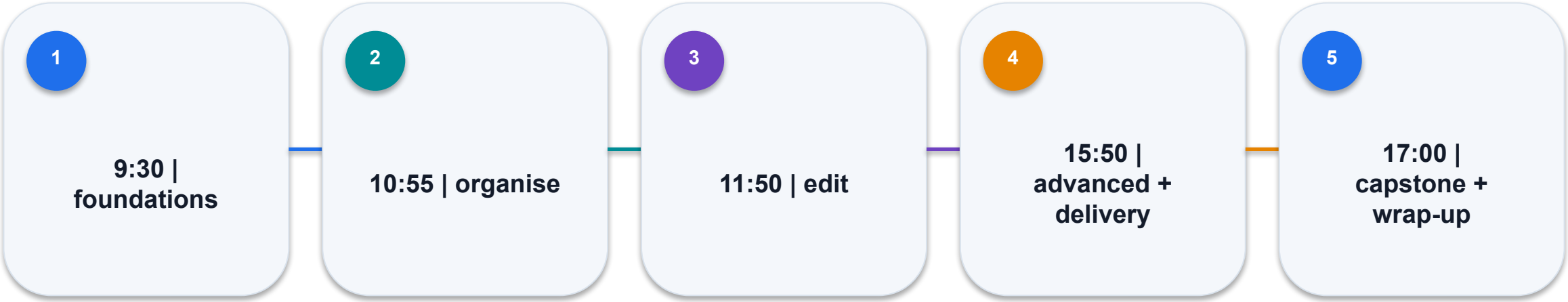
Use only approved images and protect personal metadata.

One-Day Learning Journey



7.5 INSTRUCTIONAL HOURS | 9:30 AM-5:30 PM

Lesson Plan



Access the Course Activities

Every activity has its own folder with source images, a realistic production scenario, detailed workflow, worksheet, and acceptance checklist in Markdown and PDF.

OPTION A | CLONE

```
git clone
https://github.com/tertiarycourses/C200-
Adobe-Lightroom-Masterclass.git
```

OPTION B | DOWNLOAD

Open GitHub > Code > Download ZIP

https://github.com/tertiarycourses/C200-Adobe-Lightroom-Masterclass

SECTION 01

Get Started on Digital Imagery Techniques Using Lightroom

ecosystem | workspace | brief | ingest | cull | organise | experiment

Observe the image. State the intent. Make a controlled change. Verify the result.



Lightroom Is a Non-Destructive Production System

Treat every edit as a reversible decision, not a one-way alteration.

- **Original pixels remain intact**
- Edits are stored as instructions
- Versions support safe experimentation
- Exports create delivery copies



Lightroom Is a Non-Destructive Production System | What mastery looks like

1

Original pixels remain intact

Connect the control or decision to the brief, inspect the evidence, and compare the result.

2

Edits are stored as instructions

Connect the control or decision to the brief, inspect the evidence, and compare the result.

3

Versions support safe experimentation

Connect the control or decision to the brief, inspect the evidence, and compare the result.

4

Exports create delivery copies

Connect the control or decision to the brief, inspect the evidence, and compare the result.

CASE LENS

Lightroom Is a Non-Destructive Production System | Quality lens

SIGNAL

Watch for editing the only copy.

RISK

An unexamined edit can create artefacts, inconsistency, rights risk, or a delivery failure.

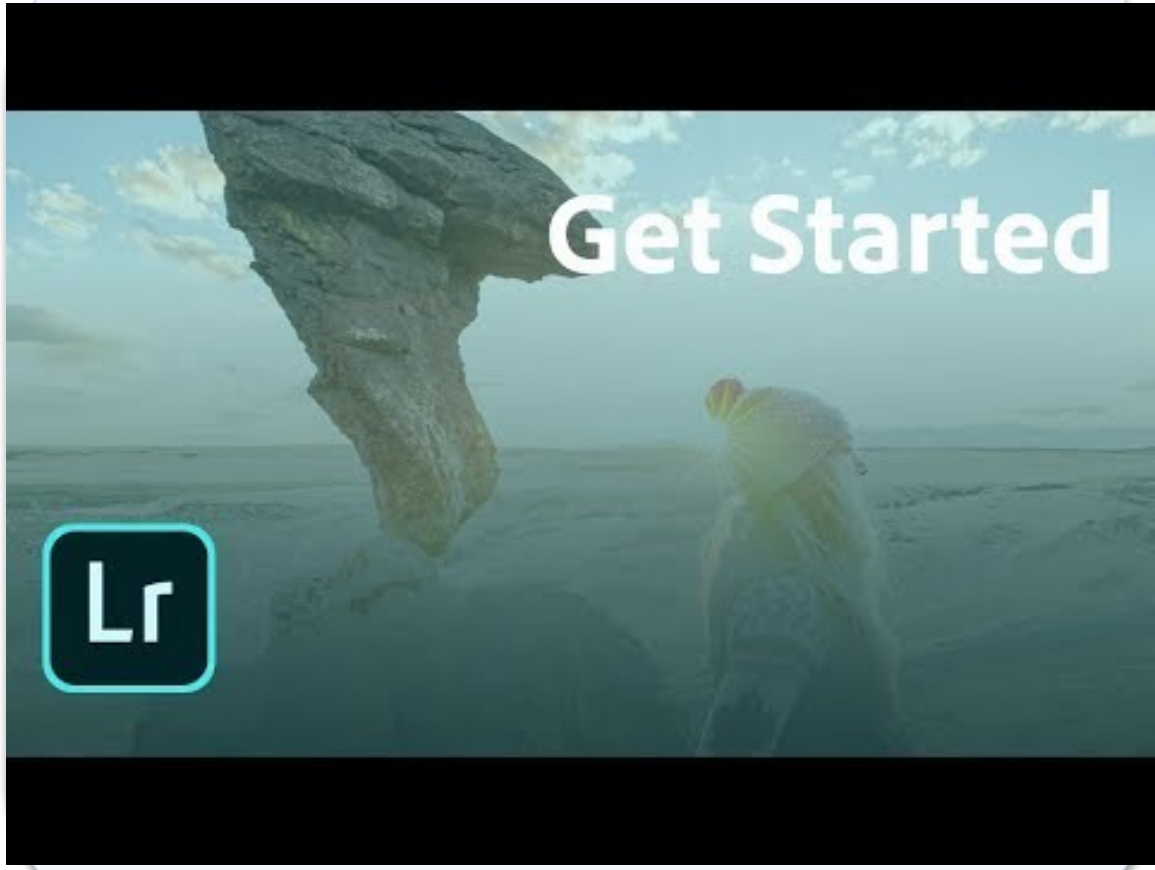
BETTER MOVE

Preserve the original, compare versions, and export derivatives.

Choose the Right Lightroom

The right tool is the one whose storage and collaboration model matches the job.

- **Lightroom: cloud-first consistency**
- Lightroom Classic: local catalog control
- Web and mobile: review and capture
- Photoshop: pixel-level compositing



Choose the Right Lightroom | What mastery looks like

1

Lightroom: cloud-first consistency

Connect the control or decision to the brief, inspect the evidence, and compare the result.

2

Lightroom Classic: local catalog control

Connect the control or decision to the brief, inspect the evidence, and compare the result.

3

Web and mobile: review and capture

Connect the control or decision to the brief, inspect the evidence, and compare the result.

4

Photoshop: pixel-level compositing

Connect the control or decision to the brief, inspect the evidence, and compare the result.

Choose the Right Lightroom | Decision loop



Build a Colour-Aware Workspace

A trustworthy edit begins with a trustworthy viewing environment.

- **Calibrated display and neutral light**
- Fast storage with reliable backup
- Enough memory and GPU headroom
- Consistent viewing conditions



Build a Colour-Aware Workspace | What mastery looks like

1

Calibrated display and neutral light

Connect the control or decision to the brief, inspect the evidence, and compare the result.

2

Fast storage with reliable backup

Connect the control or decision to the brief, inspect the evidence, and compare the result.

3

Enough memory and GPU headroom

Connect the control or decision to the brief, inspect the evidence, and compare the result.

4

Consistent viewing conditions

Connect the control or decision to the brief, inspect the evidence, and compare the result.

Build a Colour-Aware Workspace | Quality lens

SIGNAL

Watch for editing under coloured light.

RISK

An unexamined edit can create artefacts, inconsistency, rights risk, or a delivery failure.

BETTER MOVE

Control the room, display, storage, and backup before judging colour.

Start with a Stakeholder Creative Brief

A beautiful image can still fail if it solves the wrong brief.

- **Audience and use**
- Required mood and message
- Non-negotiable brand constraints
- Approval criteria and deadline



Start with a Stakeholder Creative Brief | What mastery looks like

1

Audience and use

Connect the control or decision to the brief, inspect the evidence, and compare the result.

2

Required mood and message

Connect the control or decision to the brief, inspect the evidence, and compare the result.

3

Non-negotiable brand constraints

Connect the control or decision to the brief, inspect the evidence, and compare the result.

4

Approval criteria and deadline

Connect the control or decision to the brief, inspect the evidence, and compare the result.

Start with a Stakeholder Creative Brief | Decision loop



Image Materials and File Decisions

File format is a production choice: latitude, compatibility, size, and provenance trade places.

- **RAW retains editing latitude**
- JPEG is compact and processed
- HEIF/WebP balance size and quality
- DNG can support archival workflows



Image Materials and File Decisions | What mastery looks like

1

RAW retains editing latitude

Connect the control or decision to the brief, inspect the evidence, and compare the result.

2

JPEG is compact and processed

Connect the control or decision to the brief, inspect the evidence, and compare the result.

3

HEIF/WebP balance size and quality

Connect the control or decision to the brief, inspect the evidence, and compare the result.

4

DNG can support archival workflows

Connect the control or decision to the brief, inspect the evidence, and compare the result.

Image Materials and File Decisions | Quality lens

SIGNAL

Watch for assuming every file behaves like RAW.

RISK

An unexamined edit can create artefacts, inconsistency, rights risk, or a delivery failure.

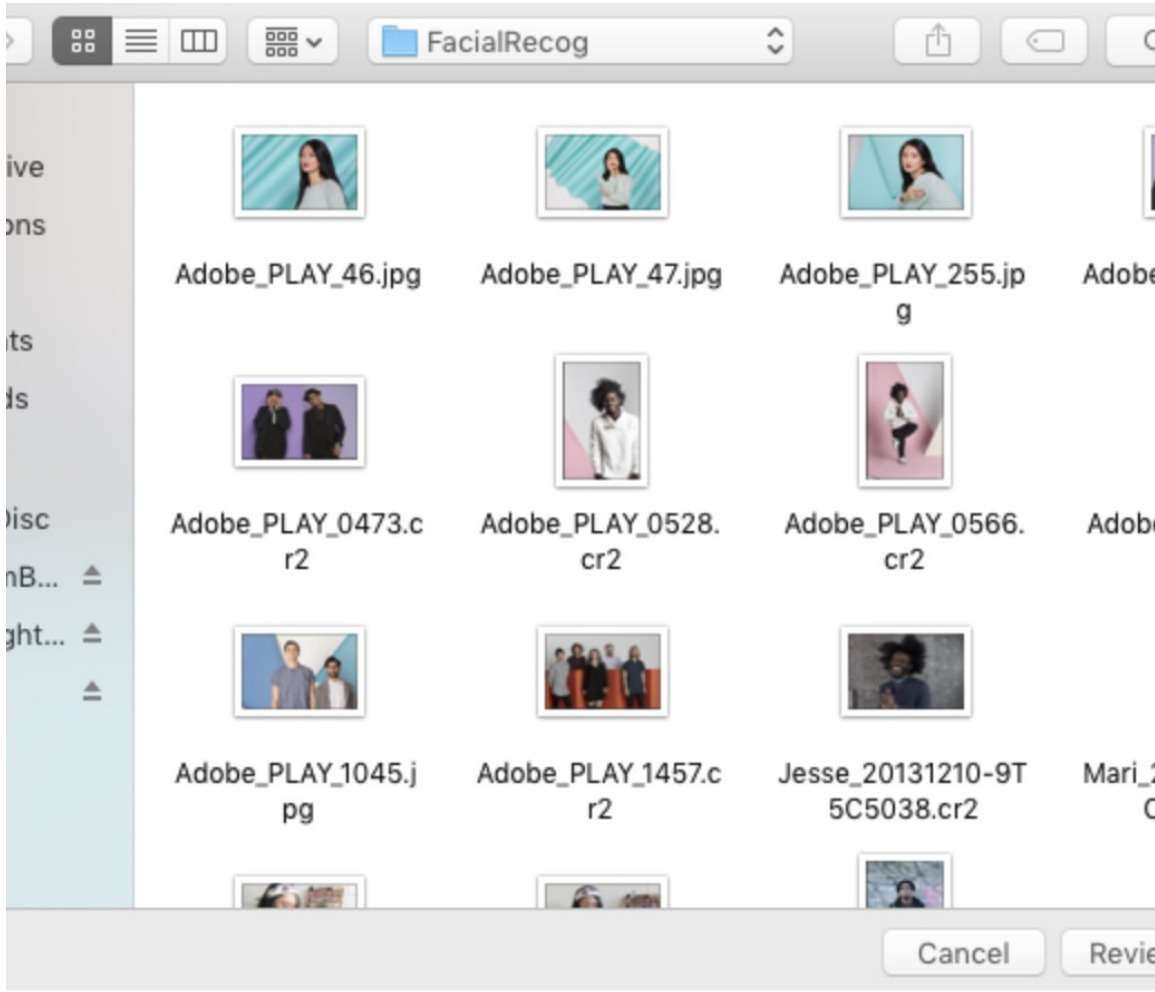
BETTER MOVE

Inspect capture format and destination before choosing the workflow.

Ingest Without Losing Control

Import is where asset control begins—not an administrative afterthought.

- **Verify source and destination**
- Avoid duplicate imports
- Name the project and album
- Confirm backup and sync state



Ingest Without Losing Control | What mastery looks like

1

Verify source and destination

Connect the control or decision to the brief, inspect the evidence, and compare the result.

2

Avoid duplicate imports

Connect the control or decision to the brief, inspect the evidence, and compare the result.

3

Name the project and album

Connect the control or decision to the brief, inspect the evidence, and compare the result.

4

Confirm backup and sync state

Connect the control or decision to the brief, inspect the evidence, and compare the result.

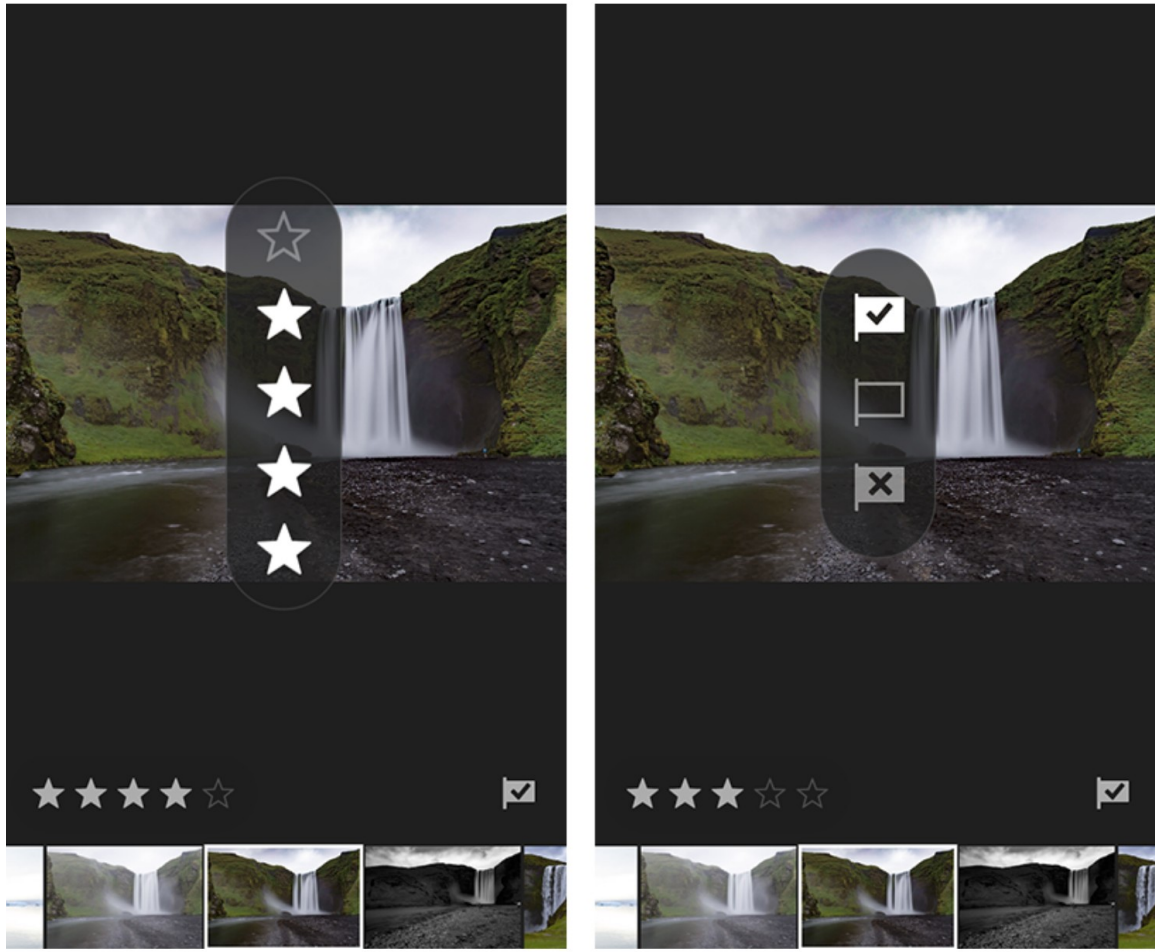
Ingest Without Losing Control | Decision loop



Cull for Story, Quality, and Risk

The strongest edit cannot rescue the wrong frame.

- **Technical quality**
- Expression and decisive moment
- Visual variety
- Rights and stakeholder fit



(Left) Rating a photo. (Right) Flagging a photo in Rate and Review panel.

Cull for Story, Quality, and Risk | What mastery looks like

1

Technical quality

Connect the control or decision to the brief, inspect the evidence, and compare the result.

2

Expression and decisive moment

Connect the control or decision to the brief, inspect the evidence, and compare the result.

3

Visual variety

Connect the control or decision to the brief, inspect the evidence, and compare the result.

4

Rights and stakeholder fit

Connect the control or decision to the brief, inspect the evidence, and compare the result.

Cull for Story, Quality, and Risk | Quality lens

SIGNAL

Watch for rating only sharpness.

RISK

An unexamined edit can create artefacts, inconsistency, rights risk, or a delivery failure.

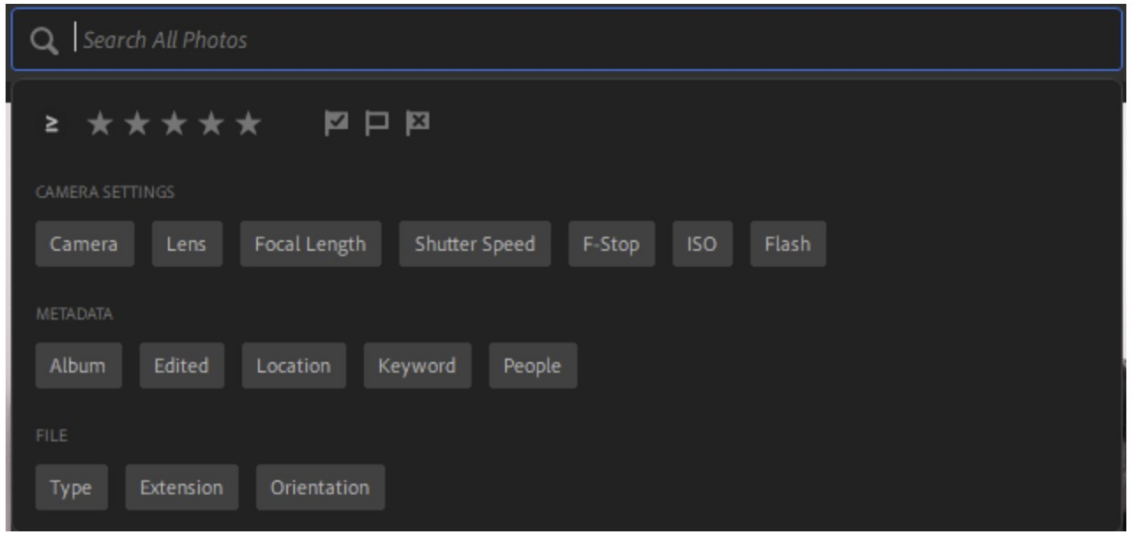
BETTER MOVE

Select against the brief, narrative value, technical quality, and usage rights.

Organise for Retrieval

An image library creates value only when the right asset can be found again.

- **Albums and folders**
- Flags, stars, and colour labels
- Keywords and metadata
- Natural-language and facet search



Search photos based on camera settings, metadata, file, or facets

Organise for Retrieval | What mastery looks like

1

Albums and folders

Connect the control or decision to the brief, inspect the evidence, and compare the result.

2

Flags, stars, and colour labels

Connect the control or decision to the brief, inspect the evidence, and compare the result.

3

Keywords and metadata

Connect the control or decision to the brief, inspect the evidence, and compare the result.

4

Natural-language and facet search

Connect the control or decision to the brief, inspect the evidence, and compare the result.

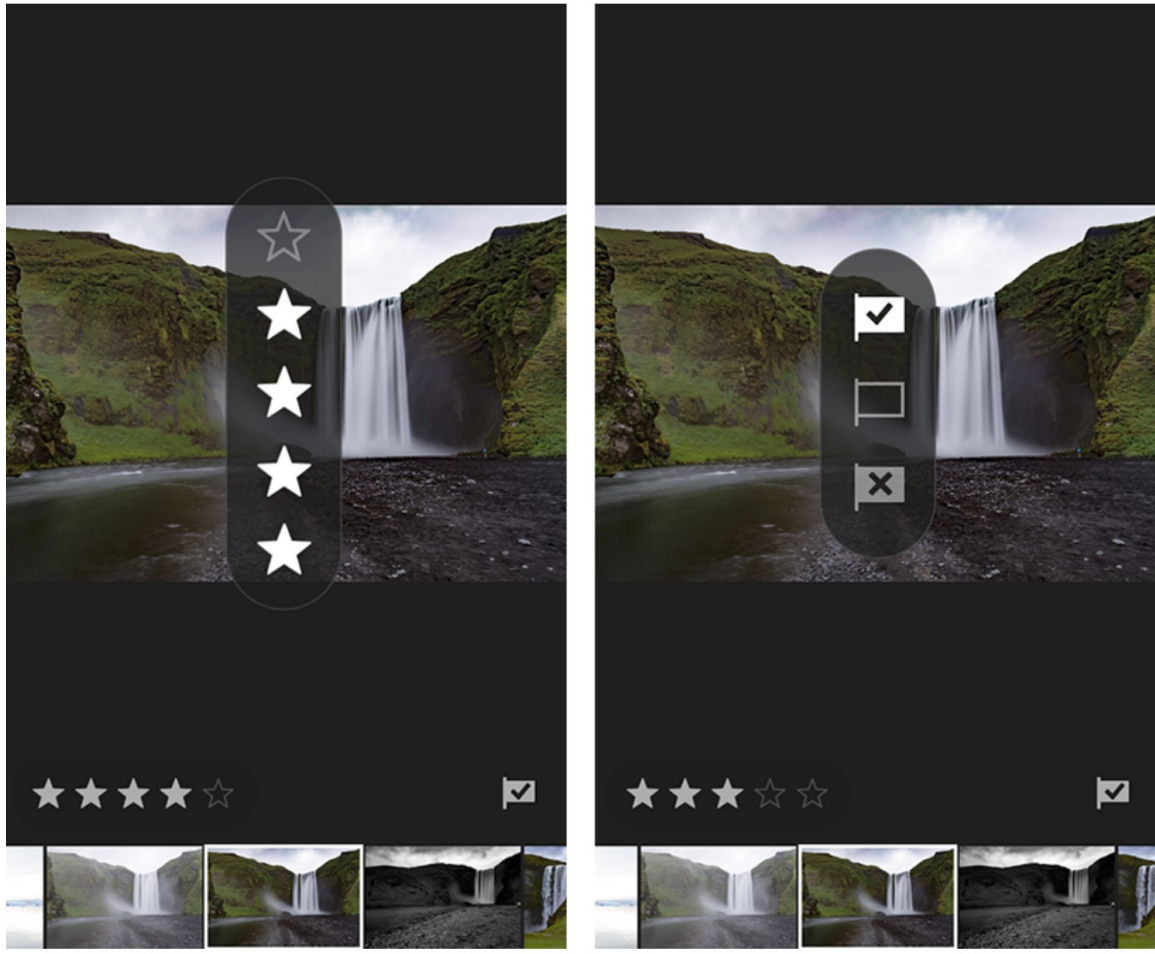
Organise for Retrieval | Decision loop



Experiment with Versions and Comparisons

Controlled comparison turns taste into a learnable editing method.

- **Create alternate versions**
- Change one variable at a time
- Use before/after evidence
- Record stakeholder decisions



(Left) Rating a photo. (Right) Flagging a photo in Rate and Review panel.

Experiment with Versions and Comparisons | What mastery looks like

1

Create alternate versions

Connect the control or decision to the brief, inspect the evidence, and compare the result.

2

Change one variable at a time

Connect the control or decision to the brief, inspect the evidence, and compare the result.

3

Use before/after evidence

Connect the control or decision to the brief, inspect the evidence, and compare the result.

4

Record stakeholder decisions

Connect the control or decision to the brief, inspect the evidence, and compare the result.

CASE LENS

Experiment with Versions and Comparisons | Quality lens

SIGNAL

Watch for random slider wandering.

RISK

An unexamined edit can create artefacts, inconsistency, rights risk, or a delivery failure.

BETTER MOVE

Set a hypothesis, make one purposeful change, compare, and record.

MASTER EDITOR PRINCIPLE

“Treat every edit as a reversible decision, not a one-way alteration.”

Use this as the topic's decision rule, then prove it through the activity evidence.

ORIGINAL COURSE MAXIM

Activity 01 | Stakeholder Brief and Colour-Safe Workspace

Topic 1

BrightFrame Studio has been hired by a Singapore wellness brand to prepare a calm, premium hero photograph for a mobile campaign. The brand manager wants natural skin and product colour; the photographer wants a warmer editorial mood; the campaign lead needs a 4:5 crop by 4 pm. The studio monitor has not been checked recently and mixed office lighting affects colour judgement.

STAKEHOLDER LENS

Work with Photo editor, Brand manager, Photographer.

EVIDENCE

Produce creative-brief translation worksheet and workspace readiness checklist.

QUALITY GATE

Every subjective preference has an observable criterion.

Full click-by-click workflow, scenario, questions, evidence templates, and acceptance criteria are in the Learner Guide and activity PDF pack.

REAL-WORKPLACE PRACTICE

Activity 02 | Marina Bay Event Library: Cull, Organise, and Retrieve

Topic 1

A hospitality group has 16 event photographs from a launch night. Marketing needs six images that show people, venue atmosphere, product detail, and a clean hero frame. The library must support later retrieval by campaign, subject, location, and approval status without duplicating originals.

STAKEHOLDER LENS

Work with Digital asset lead, Marketing stakeholder, Event photographer.

EVIDENCE

Produce six-image final-selects album and culling rationale.

QUALITY GATE

Album count matches the supplied set.

Full click-by-click workflow, scenario, questions, evidence templates, and acceptance criteria are in the Learner Guide and activity PDF pack.

Topic 1 | Evidence of skill

PROOF OF EDITING SKILL

The brief, edit decisions, before/after evidence, quality checks, stakeholder response, rights status, and output specification tell one coherent story.

Lunch Break

45 minutes

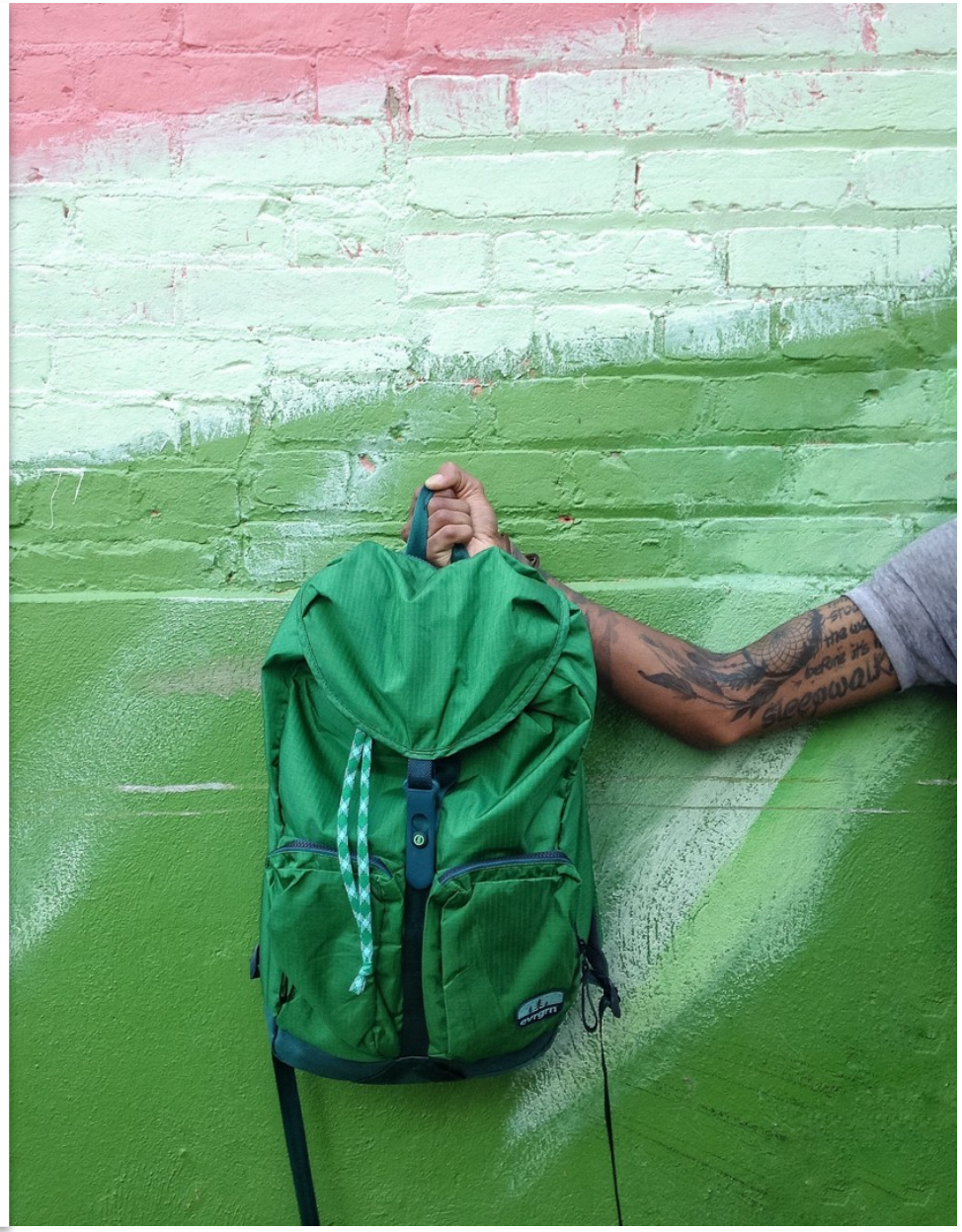
Rest your eyes. Return ready to judge detail and colour accurately.

SECTION 02

Evaluate Digital Imaging Capabilities Using Lightroom

design | tone | colour | geometry | detail | masks | AI | workflow order

Observe the image. State the intent. Make a controlled change. Verify the result.



Read the Image Before Editing

Diagnosis should lead the sliders; the sliders should never lead the diagnosis.

- **Subject and visual hierarchy**
- Histogram and clipping
- Colour cast and skin tone
- Distracting edges and geometry



Read the Image Before Editing | What mastery looks like

1

Subject and visual hierarchy

Connect the control or decision to the brief, inspect the evidence, and compare the result.

2

Histogram and clipping

Connect the control or decision to the brief, inspect the evidence, and compare the result.

3

Colour cast and skin tone

Connect the control or decision to the brief, inspect the evidence, and compare the result.

4

Distracting edges and geometry

Connect the control or decision to the brief, inspect the evidence, and compare the result.

Read the Image Before Editing | Quality lens

SIGNAL

Watch for editing by preset preview.

RISK

An unexamined edit can create artefacts, inconsistency, rights risk, or a delivery failure.

BETTER MOVE

State the visual problem, intended response, and evidence of improvement.

Design Principles Guide Every Edit

Editing is design under evidence: every adjustment should strengthen the viewer's path.

- **Contrast directs attention**
- Balance stabilises the frame
- Colour creates mood and unity
- Negative space improves emphasis



Design Principles Guide Every Edit | What mastery looks like

1

Contrast directs attention

Connect the control or decision to the brief, inspect the evidence, and compare the result.

2

Balance stabilises the frame

Connect the control or decision to the brief, inspect the evidence, and compare the result.

3

Colour creates mood and unity

Connect the control or decision to the brief, inspect the evidence, and compare the result.

4

Negative space improves emphasis

Connect the control or decision to the brief, inspect the evidence, and compare the result.

Design Principles Guide Every Edit | Decision loop



Histogram and Tonal Range

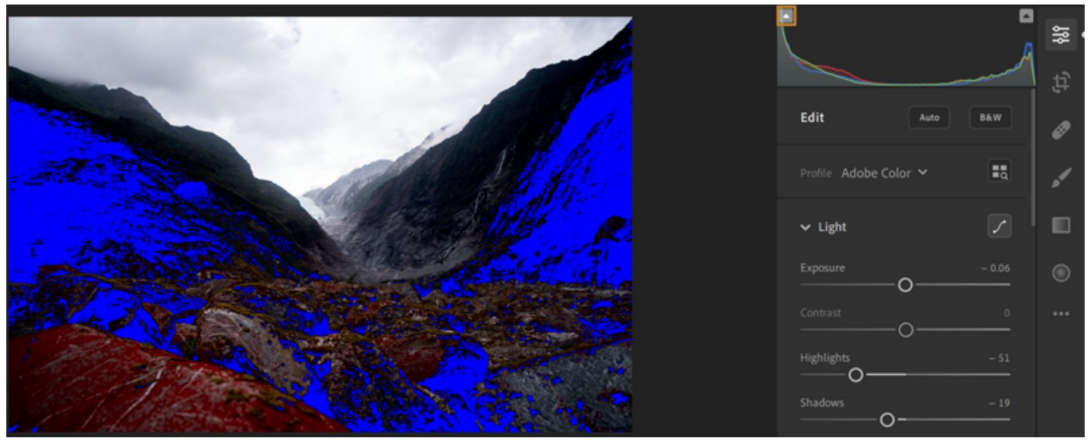
A strong tonal edit protects important detail while preserving intentional contrast.

Exposure moves overall brightness

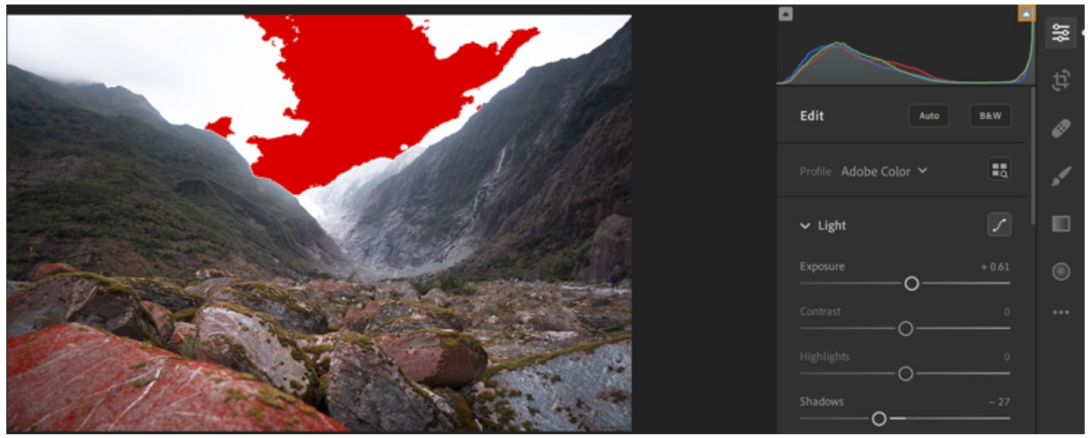
Highlights and shadows recover zones

Whites and blacks set endpoints

Clipping reveals lost information



A blue overlay mask indicates areas in the photo where shadows are clipped.



A red overlay mask indicates areas in the photo where highlights are clipped.

Histogram and Tonal Range | What mastery looks like

1

Exposure moves overall brightness

Connect the control or decision to the brief, inspect the evidence, and compare the result.

2

Highlights and shadows recover zones

Connect the control or decision to the brief, inspect the evidence, and compare the result.

3

Whites and blacks set endpoints

Connect the control or decision to the brief, inspect the evidence, and compare the result.

4

Clipping reveals lost information

Connect the control or decision to the brief, inspect the evidence, and compare the result.

Histogram and Tonal Range | Quality lens

SIGNAL

Watch for flat recovery everywhere.

RISK

An unexamined edit can create artefacts, inconsistency, rights risk, or a delivery failure.

BETTER MOVE

Use the histogram as evidence, then judge the subject and mood visually.

Tone Curve: Shape, Not Decoration

The curve is a map of relationships between input and output tone.

- **Lift or lower tonal regions**
- Create controlled contrast
- Protect endpoints
- Use channel curves for colour balance



Tone Curve: Shape, Not Decoration | What mastery looks like

1

Lift or lower tonal regions

Connect the control or decision to the brief, inspect the evidence, and compare the result.

2

Create controlled contrast

Connect the control or decision to the brief, inspect the evidence, and compare the result.

3

Protect endpoints

Connect the control or decision to the brief, inspect the evidence, and compare the result.

4

Use channel curves for colour balance

Connect the control or decision to the brief, inspect the evidence, and compare the result.

Tone Curve: Shape, Not Decoration | Decision loop



White Balance and Colour Intent

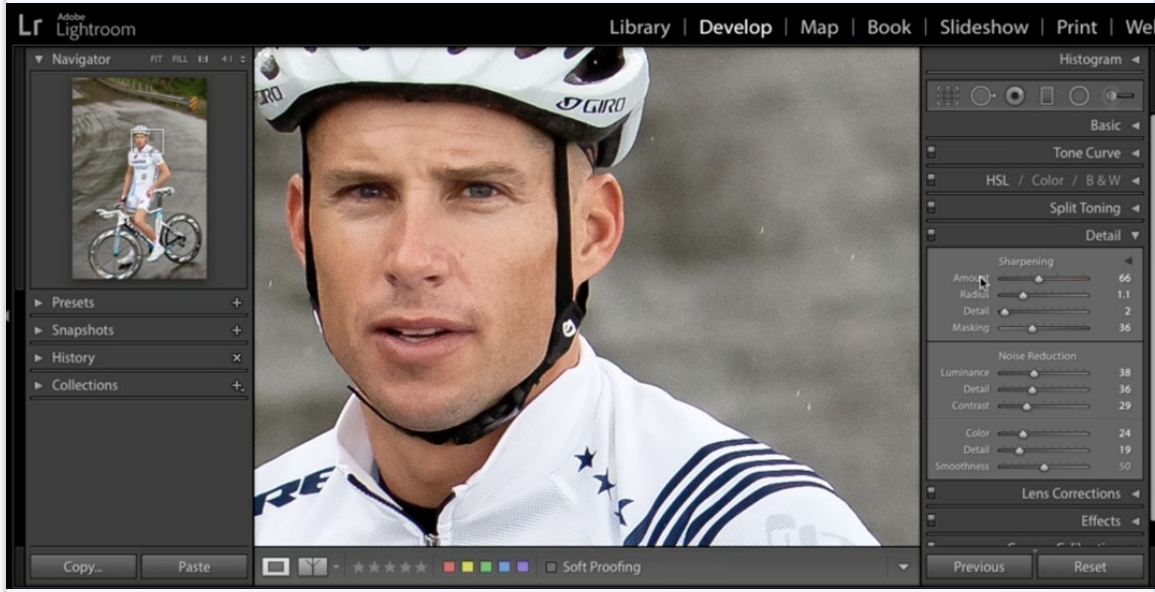
Neutral is not always the goal; believable intention is.

Temperature handles blue-yellow

Tint handles green-magenta

Vibrance protects already-saturated colour

Saturation moves all colours together



White Balance and Colour Intent | What mastery looks like

1

Temperature handles blue-yellow

Connect the control or decision to the brief, inspect the evidence, and compare the result.

2

Tint handles green-magenta

Connect the control or decision to the brief, inspect the evidence, and compare the result.

3

Vibrance protects already-saturated colour

Connect the control or decision to the brief, inspect the evidence, and compare the result.

4

Saturation moves all colours together

Connect the control or decision to the brief, inspect the evidence, and compare the result.

CASE LENS

White Balance and Colour Intent | Quality lens

SIGNAL

Watch for orange skin or radioactive colour.

RISK

An unexamined edit can create artefacts, inconsistency, rights risk, or a delivery failure.

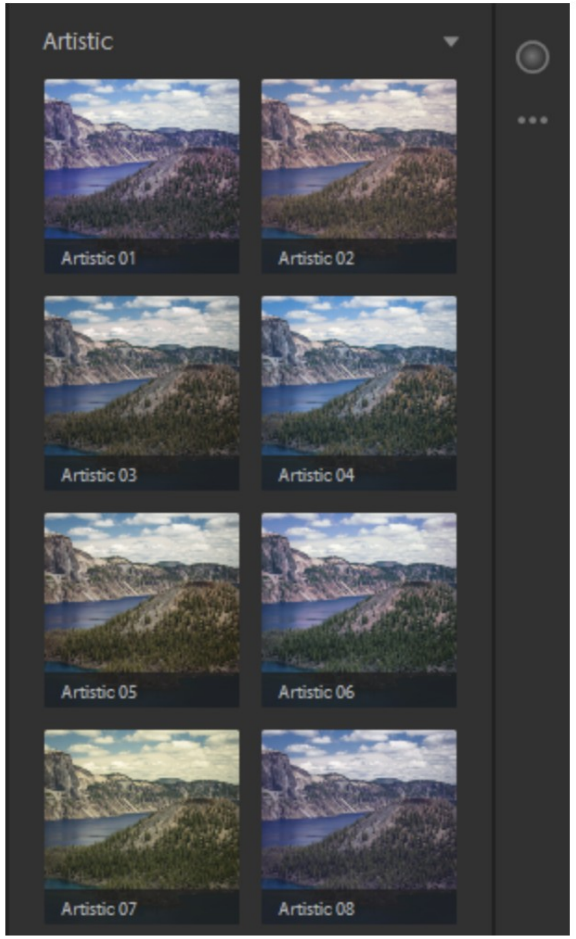
BETTER MOVE

Correct casts first, then design the palette with restraint.

Colour Mixer and Colour Grading

Colour works as a system: local decisions must still belong to one visual world.

- **Hue changes colour identity**
- Saturation changes intensity
- Luminance changes brightness
- Grading separates shadows, midtones, highlights



Artistic profiles

Colour Mixer and Colour Grading | What mastery looks like

1

Hue changes colour identity

Connect the control or decision to the brief, inspect the evidence, and compare the result.

2

Saturation changes intensity

Connect the control or decision to the brief, inspect the evidence, and compare the result.

3

Luminance changes brightness

Connect the control or decision to the brief, inspect the evidence, and compare the result.

4

Grading separates shadows, midtones, highlights

Connect the control or decision to the brief, inspect the evidence, and compare the result.

Colour Mixer and Colour Grading | Decision loop



Crop, Straighten, and Geometry

Composition is the first local adjustment: it decides what the image is about.

- **Aspect ratio follows destination**
- Crop strengthens hierarchy
- Upright corrects perspective
- Constrain crop manages empty edges



Crop, Straighten, and Geometry | What mastery looks like

1

Aspect ratio follows destination

Connect the control or decision to the brief, inspect the evidence, and compare the result.

2

Crop strengthens hierarchy

Connect the control or decision to the brief, inspect the evidence, and compare the result.

3

Upright corrects perspective

Connect the control or decision to the brief, inspect the evidence, and compare the result.

4

Constrain crop manages empty edges

Connect the control or decision to the brief, inspect the evidence, and compare the result.

CASE LENS

Crop, Straighten, and Geometry | Quality lens

SIGNAL

Watch for cropping around mistakes.

RISK

An unexamined edit can create artefacts, inconsistency, rights risk, or a delivery failure.

BETTER MOVE

Choose format from use, align geometry, and preserve meaningful breathing room.

Texture, Clarity, Dehaze, and Vignette

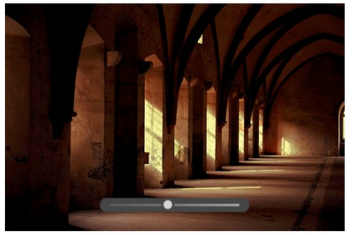
Presence controls are persuasive precisely because they are easy to overuse.

Texture targets fine detail

Clarity changes midtone edge contrast

Dehaze shifts haze and saturation

Vignette controls edge attention

Clarity	Dehaze	Vignette
		

Texture, Clarity, Dehaze, and Vignette | What mastery looks like

1

Texture targets fine detail

Connect the control or decision to the brief, inspect the evidence, and compare the result.

2

Clarity changes midtone edge contrast

Connect the control or decision to the brief, inspect the evidence, and compare the result.

3

Dehaze shifts haze and saturation

Connect the control or decision to the brief, inspect the evidence, and compare the result.

4

Vignette controls edge attention

Connect the control or decision to the brief, inspect the evidence, and compare the result.

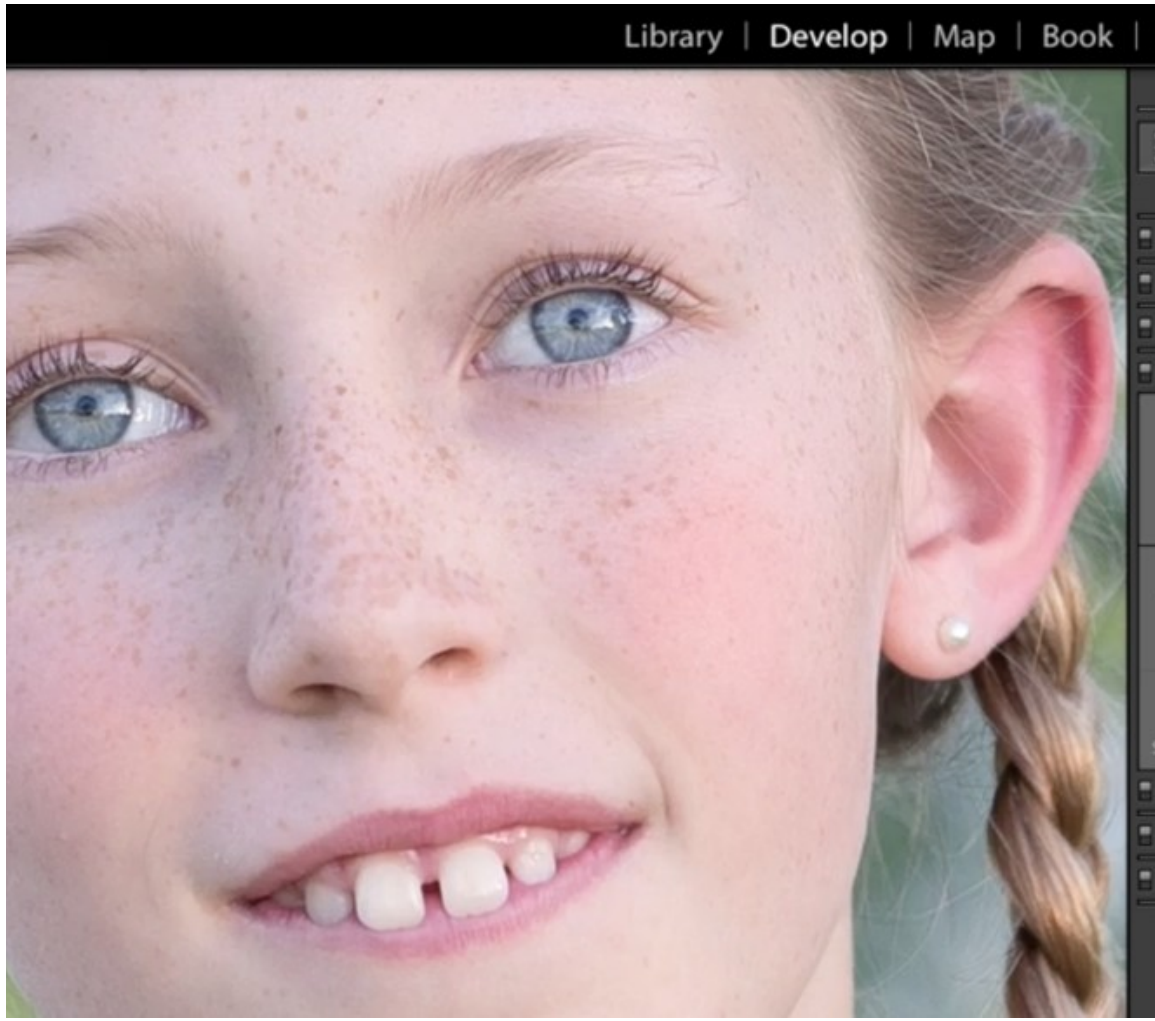
Texture, Clarity, Dehaze, and Vignette | Decision loop



Detail, Optics, and Noise

Technical polish is successful when the viewer notices the photograph, not the processing.

- **Sharpen real edges**
- Mask sharpening away from smooth areas
- Reduce luminance and colour noise
- Correct lens and chromatic aberration



Detail, Optics, and Noise | What mastery looks like

1

Sharpen real edges

Connect the control or decision to the brief, inspect the evidence, and compare the result.

2

Mask sharpening away from smooth areas

Connect the control or decision to the brief, inspect the evidence, and compare the result.

3

Reduce luminance and colour noise

Connect the control or decision to the brief, inspect the evidence, and compare the result.

4

Correct lens and chromatic aberration

Connect the control or decision to the brief, inspect the evidence, and compare the result.

CASE LENS

Detail, Optics, and Noise | Quality lens

SIGNAL

Watch for plastic surfaces.

RISK

An unexamined edit can create artefacts, inconsistency, rights risk, or a delivery failure.

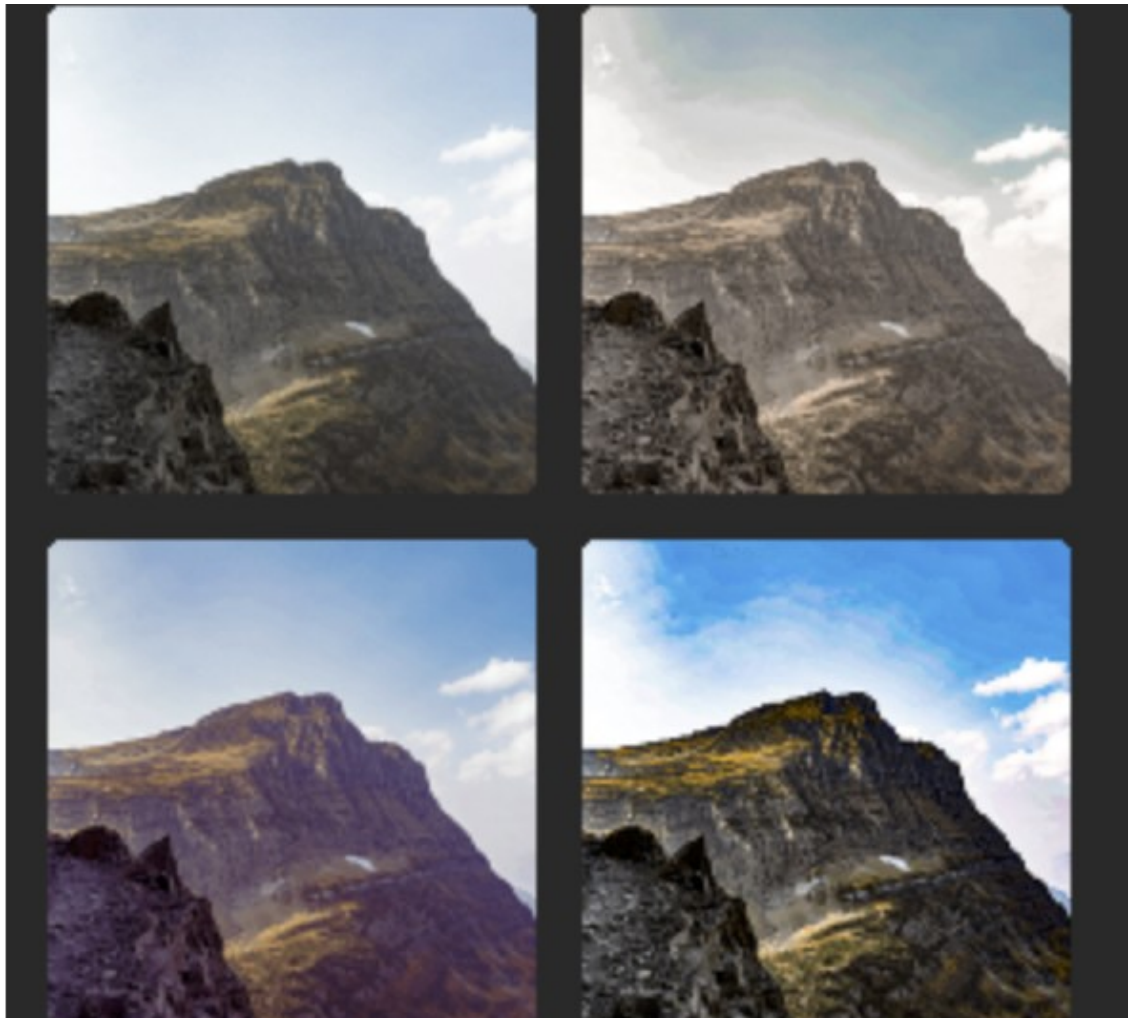
BETTER MOVE

Inspect at 100%, balance detail against noise, and judge the final output size.

Presets and Batch Consistency

Consistency comes from repeatable intent—not identical slider values.

- **Profiles set rendering foundations**
- Presets encode a starting recipe
- Copy/paste scales repeated decisions
- Synced edits still need image-by-image review



Presets and Batch Consistency | What mastery looks like

1

Profiles set rendering foundations

Connect the control or decision to the brief, inspect the evidence, and compare the result.

2

Presets encode a starting recipe

Connect the control or decision to the brief, inspect the evidence, and compare the result.

3

Copy/paste scales repeated decisions

Connect the control or decision to the brief, inspect the evidence, and compare the result.

4

Synced edits still need image-by-image review

Connect the control or decision to the brief, inspect the evidence, and compare the result.

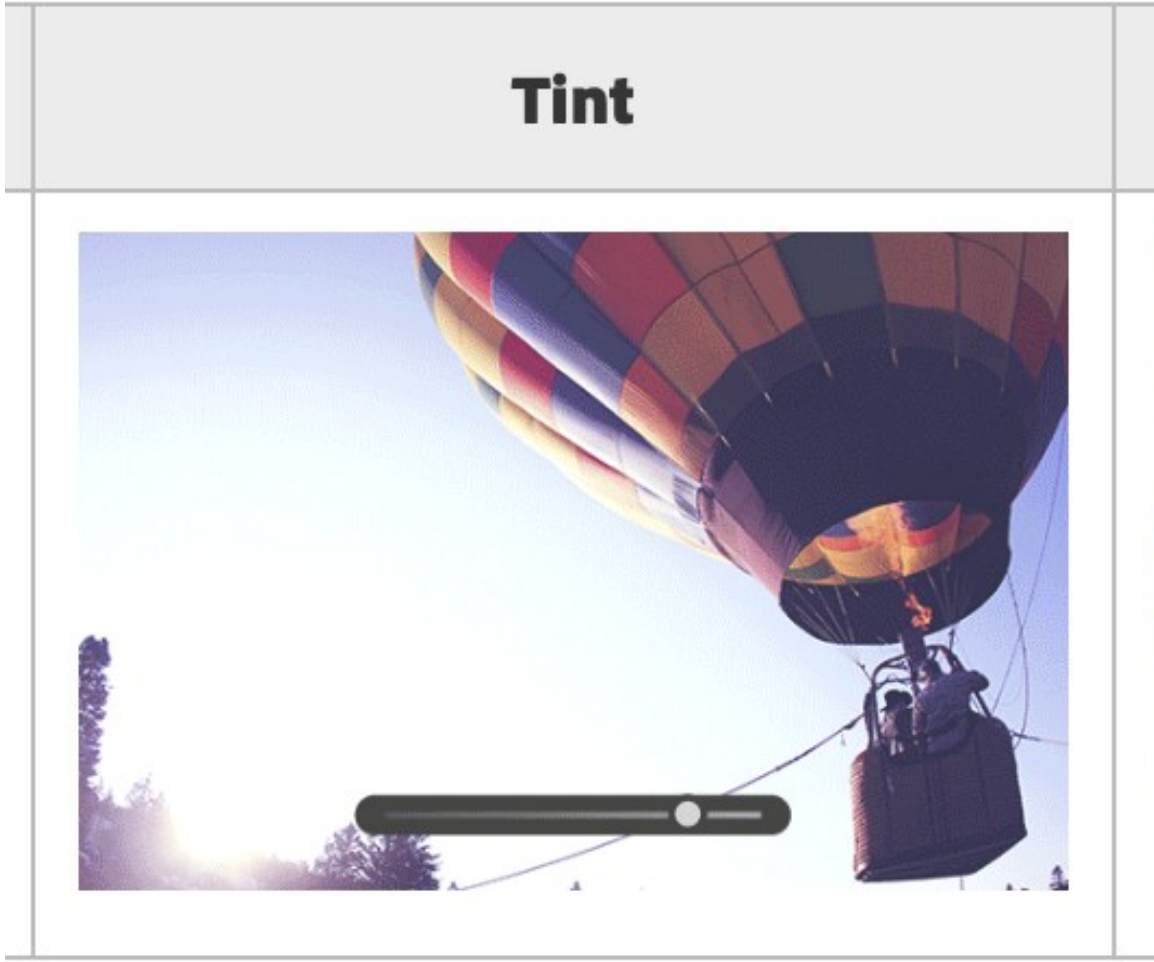
Presets and Batch Consistency | Decision loop



Global Edits Before Local Edits

A stable edit order prevents local fixes from compensating for global problems.

- **Profile and white balance**
- Tone and colour
- Crop and geometry
- Masks, retouch, and finishing



Global Edits Before Local Edits | What mastery looks like

1

Profile and white balance

Connect the control or decision to the brief, inspect the evidence, and compare the result.

2

Tone and colour

Connect the control or decision to the brief, inspect the evidence, and compare the result.

3

Crop and geometry

Connect the control or decision to the brief, inspect the evidence, and compare the result.

4

Masks, retouch, and finishing

Connect the control or decision to the brief, inspect the evidence, and compare the result.

Global Edits Before Local Edits | Quality lens

SIGNAL

Watch for masking too early.

RISK

An unexamined edit can create artefacts, inconsistency, rights risk, or a delivery failure.

BETTER MOVE

Work from broad relationships to small exceptions, then re-check the whole frame.

Masking Is Controlled Attention

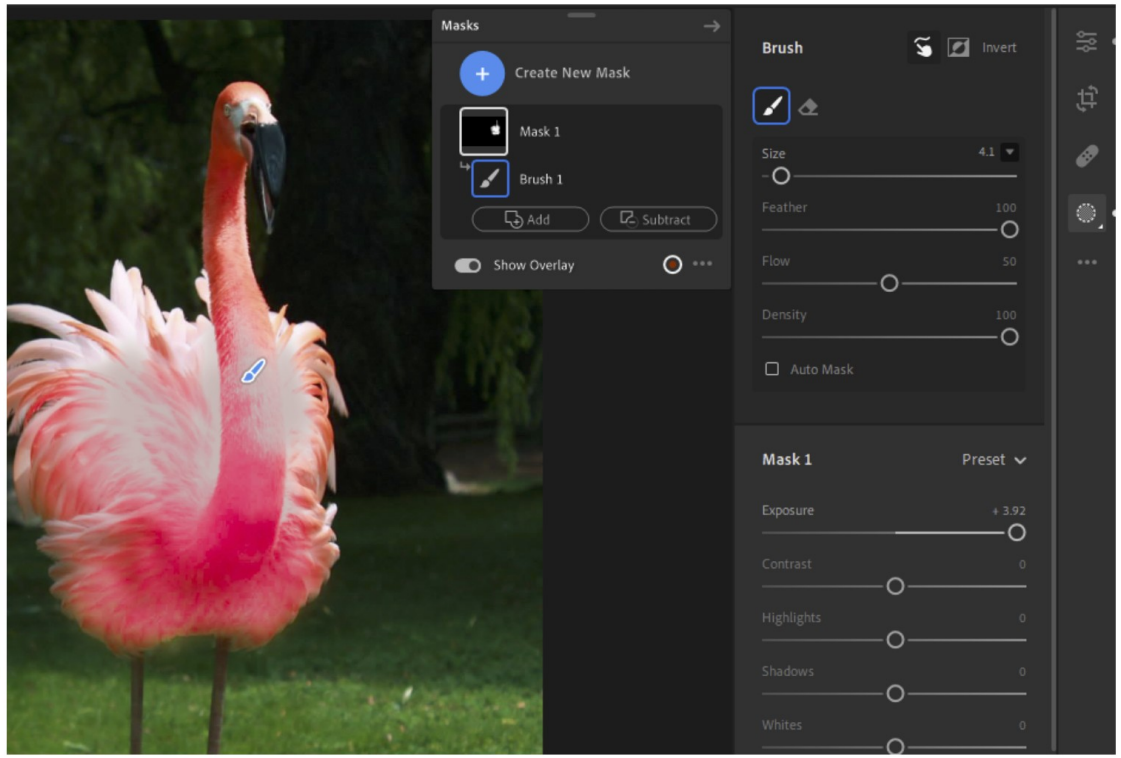
A good mask is invisible; the viewer experiences emphasis, not an edge.

AI subject, sky, people, objects, landscape

Brush, linear, and radial gradients

Colour and luminance ranges

Add, subtract, intersect, invert



Use the Brush tool to paint over areas you want to locally edit

Masking Is Controlled Attention | What mastery looks like

1

AI subject, sky, people, objects, landscape

Connect the control or decision to the brief, inspect the evidence, and compare the result.

2

Brush, linear, and radial gradients

Connect the control or decision to the brief, inspect the evidence, and compare the result.

3

Colour and luminance ranges

Connect the control or decision to the brief, inspect the evidence, and compare the result.

4

Add, subtract, intersect, invert

Connect the control or decision to the brief, inspect the evidence, and compare the result.

Masking Is Controlled Attention | Decision loop



Natural Mask Edges

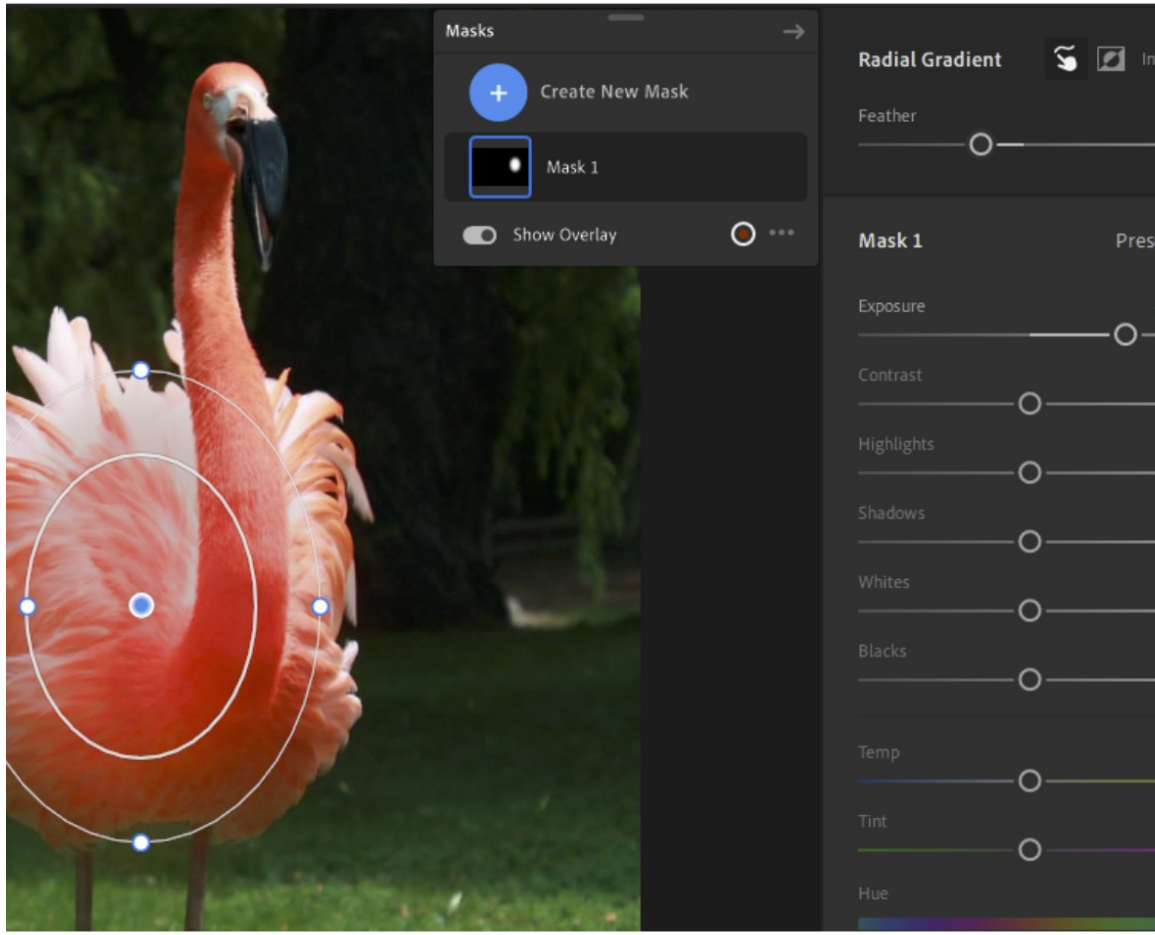
Selection quality is measured at the transition, not the centre.

Feather softens transitions

Edge expands or contracts selection

Add and subtract repair misses

Intersect limits adjustment precisely



Gradient tool to make adjustments within an oval selection

Natural Mask Edges | What mastery looks like

1

Feather softens transitions

Connect the control or decision to the brief, inspect the evidence, and compare the result.

2

Edge expands or contracts selection

Connect the control or decision to the brief, inspect the evidence, and compare the result.

3

Add and subtract repair misses

Connect the control or decision to the brief, inspect the evidence, and compare the result.

4

Intersect limits adjustment precisely

Connect the control or decision to the brief, inspect the evidence, and compare the result.

Natural Mask Edges | Quality lens

SIGNAL

Watch for halos around hair or horizons.

RISK

An unexamined edit can create artefacts, inconsistency, rights risk, or a delivery failure.

BETTER MOVE

Push the adjustment temporarily, refine the boundary, then return to a natural strength.

Retouching and Generative Remove

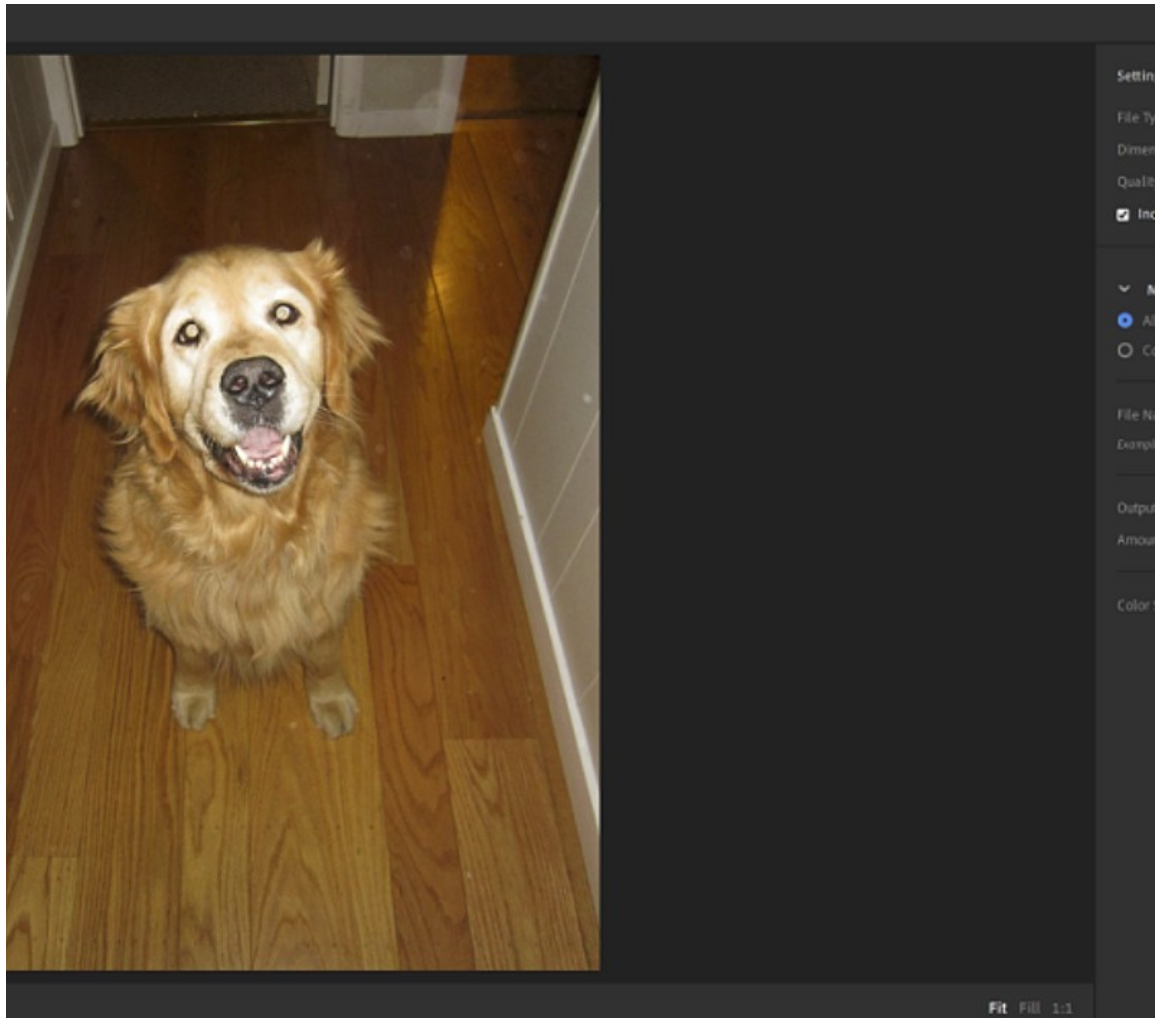
Use the least powerful tool that solves the distraction truthfully and cleanly.

Heal samples texture

Clone copies pixels

Remove handles small distractions

Generative Remove fills larger gaps



Retouching and Generative Remove | What mastery looks like

1

Heal samples texture

Connect the control or decision to the brief, inspect the evidence, and compare the result.

2

Clone copies pixels

Connect the control or decision to the brief, inspect the evidence, and compare the result.

3

Remove handles small distractions

Connect the control or decision to the brief, inspect the evidence, and compare the result.

4

Generative Remove fills larger gaps

Connect the control or decision to the brief, inspect the evidence, and compare the result.

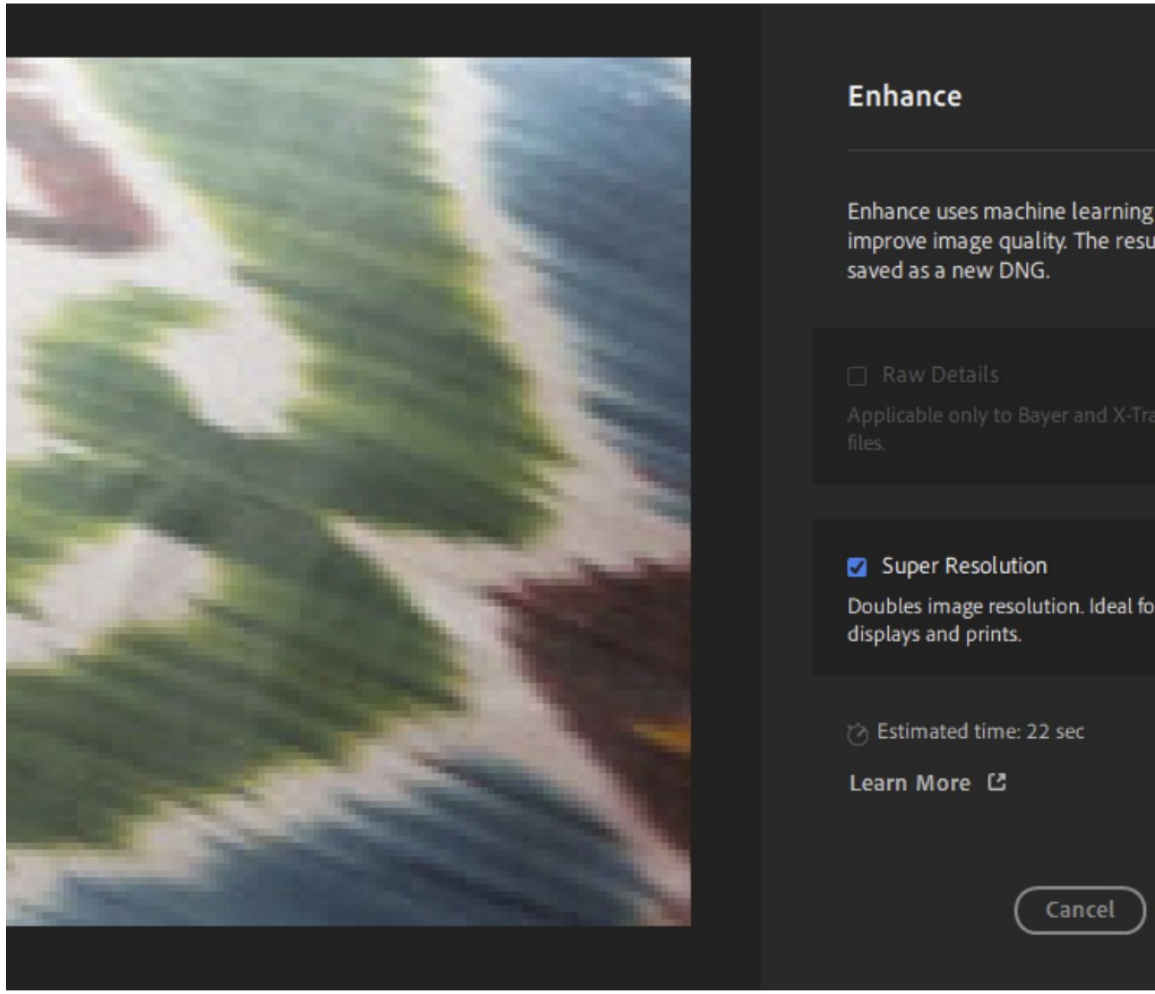
Retouching and Generative Remove | Decision loop



AI Enhancement with Human Quality Control

AI can propose pixels; the editor remains responsible for truth, artefacts, rights, and fitness for use.

- **Denoise balances noise and detail**
- AI Sharpen can recover mild blur
- Generative Upscale creates larger derivatives
- Generative Expand changes boundaries and content



AI Enhancement with Human Quality Control | What mastery looks like

1

Denoise balances noise and detail

Connect the control or decision to the brief, inspect the evidence, and compare the result.

2

AI Sharpen can recover mild blur

Connect the control or decision to the brief, inspect the evidence, and compare the result.

3

Generative Upscale creates larger derivatives

Connect the control or decision to the brief, inspect the evidence, and compare the result.

4

Generative Expand changes boundaries and content

Connect the control or decision to the brief, inspect the evidence, and compare the result.

CASE LENS

AI Enhancement with Human Quality Control | Quality lens

SIGNAL

Watch for trusting a 100% preview.

RISK

An unexamined edit can create artefacts, inconsistency, rights risk, or a delivery failure.

BETTER MOVE

Check faces, text, edges, repeated patterns, provenance, and delivery requirements.

HDR, Panorama, and Merge Decisions

Computational range is useful only when it supports a believable scene.

- **Capture overlap and exposure intentionally**
- Merge before creative finishing
- Inspect seams and ghosting
- Keep a natural dynamic range



HDR, Panorama, and Merge Decisions | What mastery looks like

1

Capture overlap and exposure intentionally

Connect the control or decision to the brief, inspect the evidence, and compare the result.

2

Merge before creative finishing

Connect the control or decision to the brief, inspect the evidence, and compare the result.

3

Inspect seams and ghosting

Connect the control or decision to the brief, inspect the evidence, and compare the result.

4

Keep a natural dynamic range

Connect the control or decision to the brief, inspect the evidence, and compare the result.

HDR, Panorama, and Merge Decisions | Decision loop



MASTER EDITOR PRINCIPLE

“Diagnosis should lead the sliders; the sliders should never lead the diagnosis.”

Use this as the topic's decision rule, then prove it through the activity evidence.

ORIGINAL COURSE MAXIM

REAL-WORKPLACE PRACTICE

Activity 03 | Artisan Bakery Product Series: Tone, Colour, and Consistency

Topic 2

A neighbourhood bakery needs a cohesive image set for its online menu. The photographs were captured under mixed lighting and vary in brightness. The food must look warm and inviting but still believable, with consistent whites and product colour across the series.

STAKEHOLDER LENS

Work with Lead editor, Bakery owner, Food stylist.

EVIDENCE

Produce before/after hero comparison and reusable global preset.

QUALITY GATE

No important clipping.

Full click-by-click workflow, scenario, questions, evidence templates, and acceptance criteria are in the Learner Guide and activity PDF pack.

REAL-WORKPLACE PRACTICE

Activity 04 | Heritage Hotel Interior: Composition, Geometry, and Local Light

Topic 2

A heritage hotel wants an interior photograph for a booking page. Vertical lines converge, the window is bright, furniture shadows are deep, and the eye is drawn away from the seating area. The final should feel spacious and calm without misrepresenting the room.

STAKEHOLDER LENS

Work with Architectural editor, Hotel marketing lead, Interior designer.

EVIDENCE

Produce corrected interior image and mask boundary inspection screenshots.

QUALITY GATE

Key lines are credible.

Full click-by-click workflow, scenario, questions, evidence templates, and acceptance criteria are in the Learner Guide and activity PDF pack.

Activity 05 | Community Portrait Campaign: Natural Masking and Retouching

Topic 2

A community campaign needs a warm portrait that feels authentic. The subject is underexposed, the background competes for attention, and small distractions are visible. The client forbids body reshaping and wants skin texture and identity preserved.

STAKEHOLDER LENS

Work with Portrait editor, Campaign producer, Subject advocate.

EVIDENCE

Produce natural portrait edit and mask-refinement evidence.

QUALITY GATE

Identity and skin texture are preserved.

Full click-by-click workflow, scenario, questions, evidence templates, and acceptance criteria are in the Learner Guide and activity PDF pack.

Activity 06 | Tourism Image Rescue: Detail, Removal, and AI Enhancement

Topic 2

A tourism team has a hazy, noisy image that needs a larger display version. There are distracting people and a sensor spot. The image is useful but borderline, so the editor must compare conventional and AI-assisted options, identify artefacts, and recommend whether it is fit for use.

STAKEHOLDER LENS

Work with Imaging specialist, Tourism art director, Authenticity reviewer.

EVIDENCE

Produce conventional and ai-assisted comparison and artefact inspection sheet.

QUALITY GATE

All AI outputs are separate from the original.

Full click-by-click workflow, scenario, questions, evidence templates, and acceptance criteria are in the Learner Guide and activity PDF pack.

Topic 2 | Evidence of skill

PROOF OF EDITING SKILL

The brief, edit decisions, before/after evidence, quality checks, stakeholder response, rights status, and output specification tell one coherent story.

Afternoon Break

10 minutes

Rest your eyes. Return ready to judge detail and colour accurately.

SECTION 03

Process of Digital Image Production

review | collaboration | IP | metadata | export | quality assurance

Observe the image. State the intent. Make a controlled change. Verify the result.



A Production Workflow Is a Decision Trail

Professional editing is repeatable because its decisions can be explained and traced.

- **Brief and rights**
- Select and edit
- Review and approve
- Export, deliver, archive



A Production Workflow Is a Decision Trail | What mastery looks like

1

Brief and rights

Connect the control or decision to the brief, inspect the evidence, and compare the result.

2

Select and edit

Connect the control or decision to the brief, inspect the evidence, and compare the result.

3

Review and approve

Connect the control or decision to the brief, inspect the evidence, and compare the result.

4

Export, deliver, archive

Connect the control or decision to the brief, inspect the evidence, and compare the result.

A Production Workflow Is a Decision Trail | Quality lens

SIGNAL

Watch for final-file mystery.

RISK

An unexamined edit can create artefacts, inconsistency, rights risk, or a delivery failure.

BETTER MOVE

Record purpose, version, approver, export specification, and rights status.

Stakeholder Review Without Slider Debate

Feedback improves when people judge outcomes, not unfamiliar controls.

Show options against the brief

Ask about message and audience

Capture one decision owner

Separate preference from requirement



Stakeholder Review Without Slider Debate | What mastery looks like

1

Show options against the brief

Connect the control or decision to the brief, inspect the evidence, and compare the result.

2

Ask about message and audience

Connect the control or decision to the brief, inspect the evidence, and compare the result.

3

Capture one decision owner

Connect the control or decision to the brief, inspect the evidence, and compare the result.

4

Separate preference from requirement

Connect the control or decision to the brief, inspect the evidence, and compare the result.

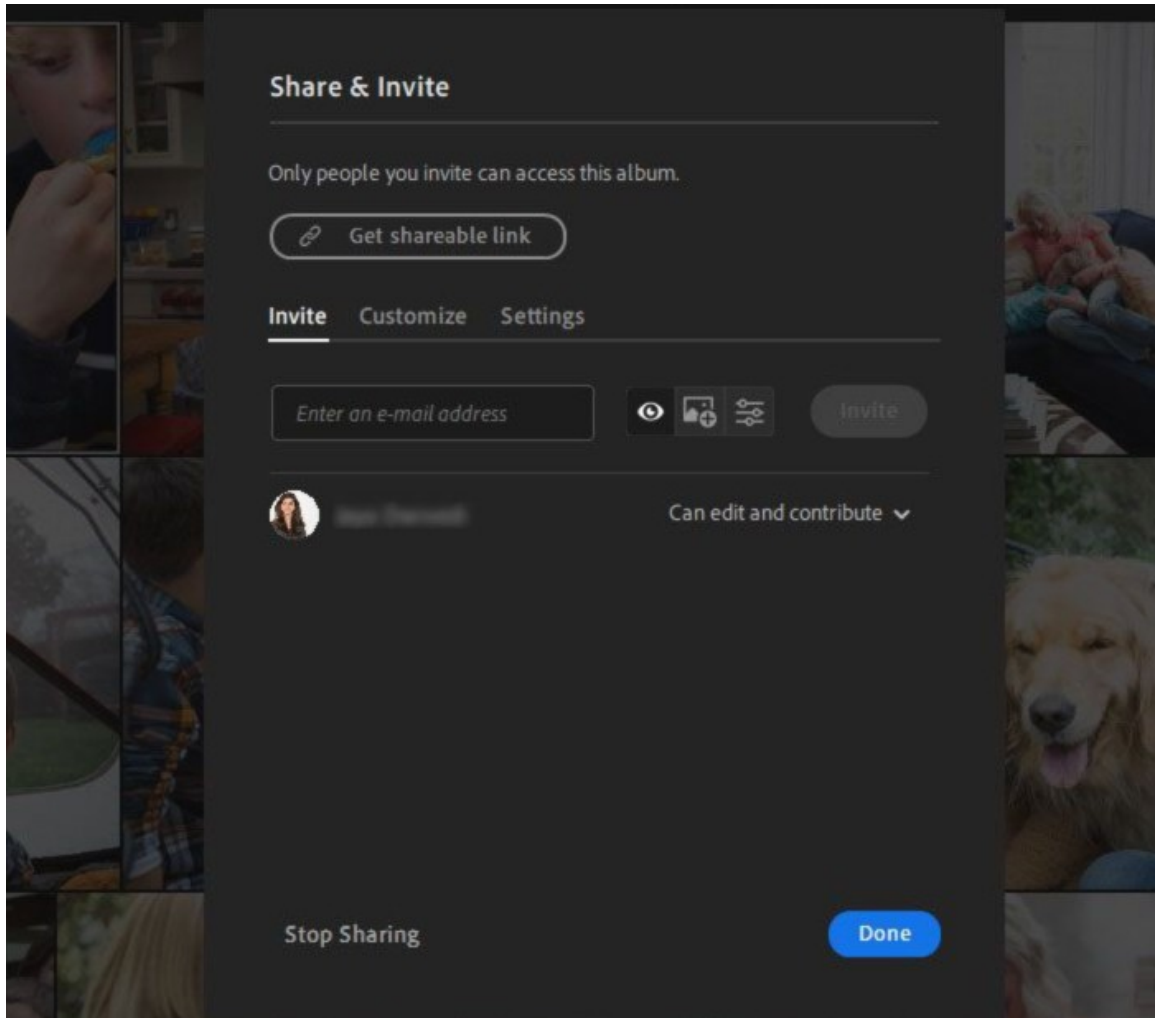
Stakeholder Review Without Slider Debate | Decision loop



Shared Albums and Collaboration Controls

Sharing is a permissions design problem as much as a presentation choice.

- **Invite-only or anyone-with-link**
- Comments and likes
- Contributor upload rights
- Download, metadata, and location settings



Shared Albums and Collaboration Controls | What mastery looks like

1

Invite-only or anyone-with-link

Connect the control or decision to the brief, inspect the evidence, and compare the result.

2

Comments and likes

Connect the control or decision to the brief, inspect the evidence, and compare the result.

3

Contributor upload rights

Connect the control or decision to the brief, inspect the evidence, and compare the result.

4

Download, metadata, and location settings

Connect the control or decision to the brief, inspect the evidence, and compare the result.

Shared Albums and Collaboration Controls | Quality lens

SIGNAL

Watch for overshared client material.

RISK

An unexamined edit can create artefacts, inconsistency, rights risk, or a delivery failure.

BETTER MOVE

Use least privilege, remove location data when needed, and review access after approval.

Copyright, Licence, and Consent

Possession of a file is not permission to publish it.

- **Copyright protects original expression**
- Licences define permitted use
- Model/property releases address consent
- Trademarks and publicity rights add constraints



Copyright, Licence, and Consent | What mastery looks like

1

Copyright protects original expression

Connect the control or decision to the brief, inspect the evidence, and compare the result.

2

Licences define permitted use

Connect the control or decision to the brief, inspect the evidence, and compare the result.

3

Model/property releases address consent

Connect the control or decision to the brief, inspect the evidence, and compare the result.

4

Trademarks and publicity rights add constraints

Connect the control or decision to the brief, inspect the evidence, and compare the result.

Copyright, Licence, and Consent | Decision loop



Generative AI, Authenticity, and Provenance

Technical possibility does not remove ethical responsibility.

- **Generated pixels can alter factual meaning**
- Content Credentials can carry provenance
- Document material AI interventions
- Editorial uses need stricter judgement



Generative AI, Authenticity, and Provenance | What mastery looks like

1

Generated pixels can alter factual meaning

Connect the control or decision to the brief, inspect the evidence, and compare the result.

2

Content Credentials can carry provenance

Connect the control or decision to the brief, inspect the evidence, and compare the result.

3

Document material AI interventions

Connect the control or decision to the brief, inspect the evidence, and compare the result.

4

Editorial uses need stricter judgement

Connect the control or decision to the brief, inspect the evidence, and compare the result.

Generative AI, Authenticity, and Provenance | Quality lens

SIGNAL

Watch for synthetic documentary detail.

RISK

An unexamined edit can create artefacts, inconsistency, rights risk, or a delivery failure.

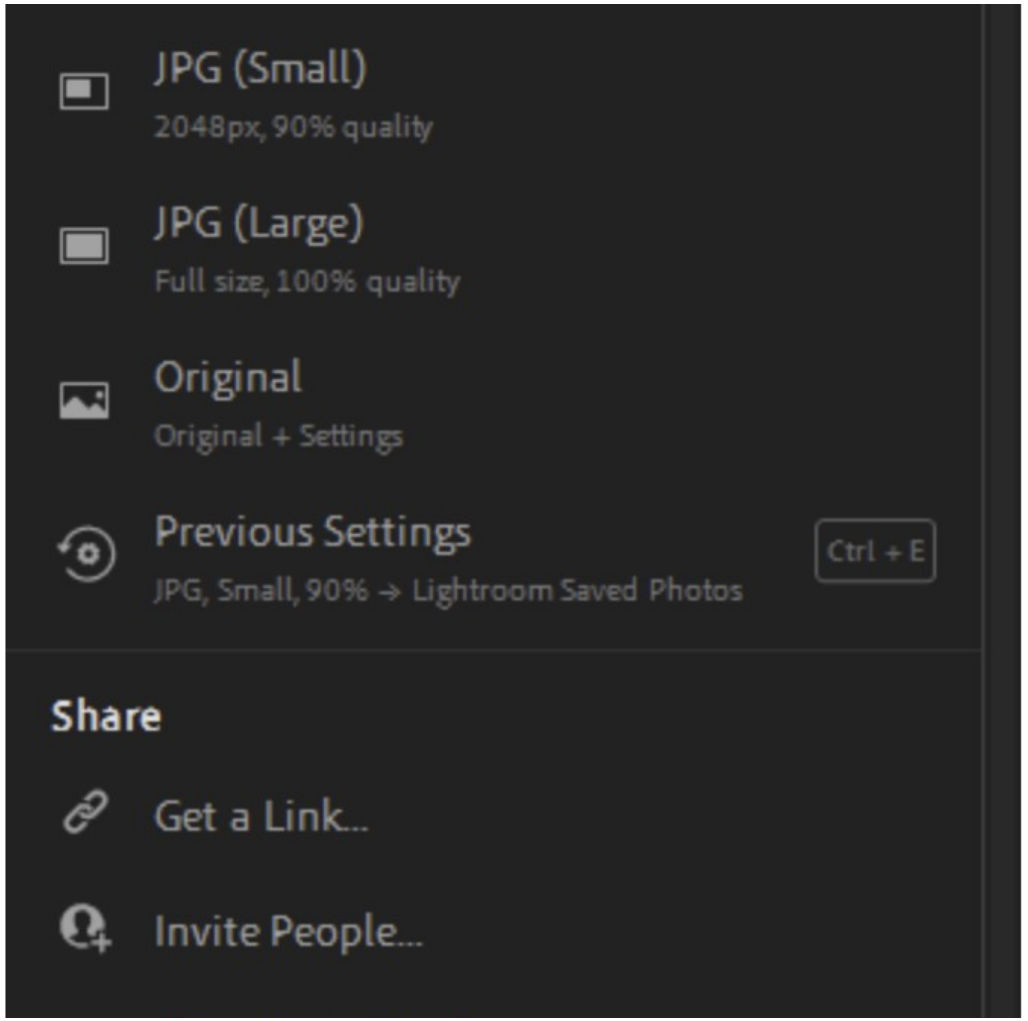
BETTER MOVE

Classify the use, preserve originals, disclose material edits, and obtain approval.

Export Specifications Follow the Destination

Export is translation: preserve the intent while meeting the destination's constraints.

- **Pixel dimensions and aspect ratio**
- JPEG quality and file size
- sRGB for common digital delivery
- Naming, watermark, and metadata



Export Specifications Follow the Destination | What mastery looks like

1

Pixel dimensions and aspect ratio

Connect the control or decision to the brief, inspect the evidence, and compare the result.

2

JPEG quality and file size

Connect the control or decision to the brief, inspect the evidence, and compare the result.

3

sRGB for common digital delivery

Connect the control or decision to the brief, inspect the evidence, and compare the result.

4

Naming, watermark, and metadata

Connect the control or decision to the brief, inspect the evidence, and compare the result.

Export Specifications Follow the Destination | Decision loop



Quality Assurance Before Delivery

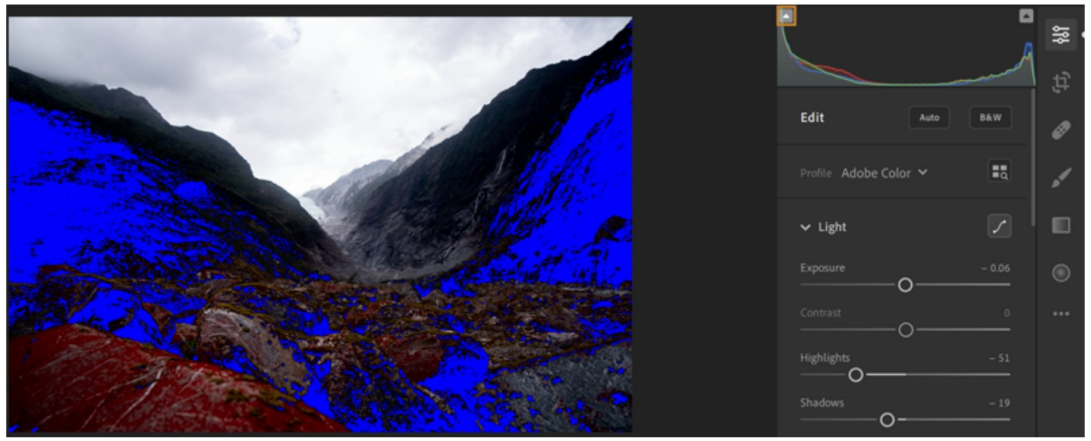
The last 2% of inspection protects 100% of client confidence.

Compare to brief and reference

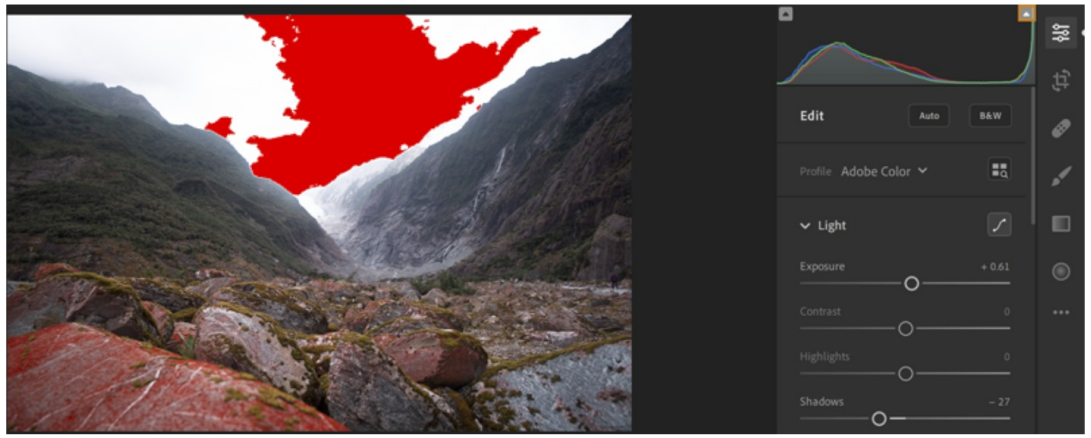
Inspect focus, artefacts, and edges

Verify colour, crop, metadata, and rights

Open the exported file on target devices



A blue overlay mask indicates areas in the photo where shadows are clipped.



A red overlay mask indicates areas in the photo where highlights are clipped.

Quality Assurance Before Delivery | What mastery looks like

1

Compare to brief and reference

Connect the control or decision to the brief, inspect the evidence, and compare the result.

2

Inspect focus, artefacts, and edges

Connect the control or decision to the brief, inspect the evidence, and compare the result.

3

Verify colour, crop, metadata, and rights

Connect the control or decision to the brief, inspect the evidence, and compare the result.

4

Open the exported file on target devices

Connect the control or decision to the brief, inspect the evidence, and compare the result.

Quality Assurance Before Delivery | Quality lens

SIGNAL

Watch for shipping from memory.

RISK

An unexamined edit can create artefacts, inconsistency, rights risk, or a delivery failure.

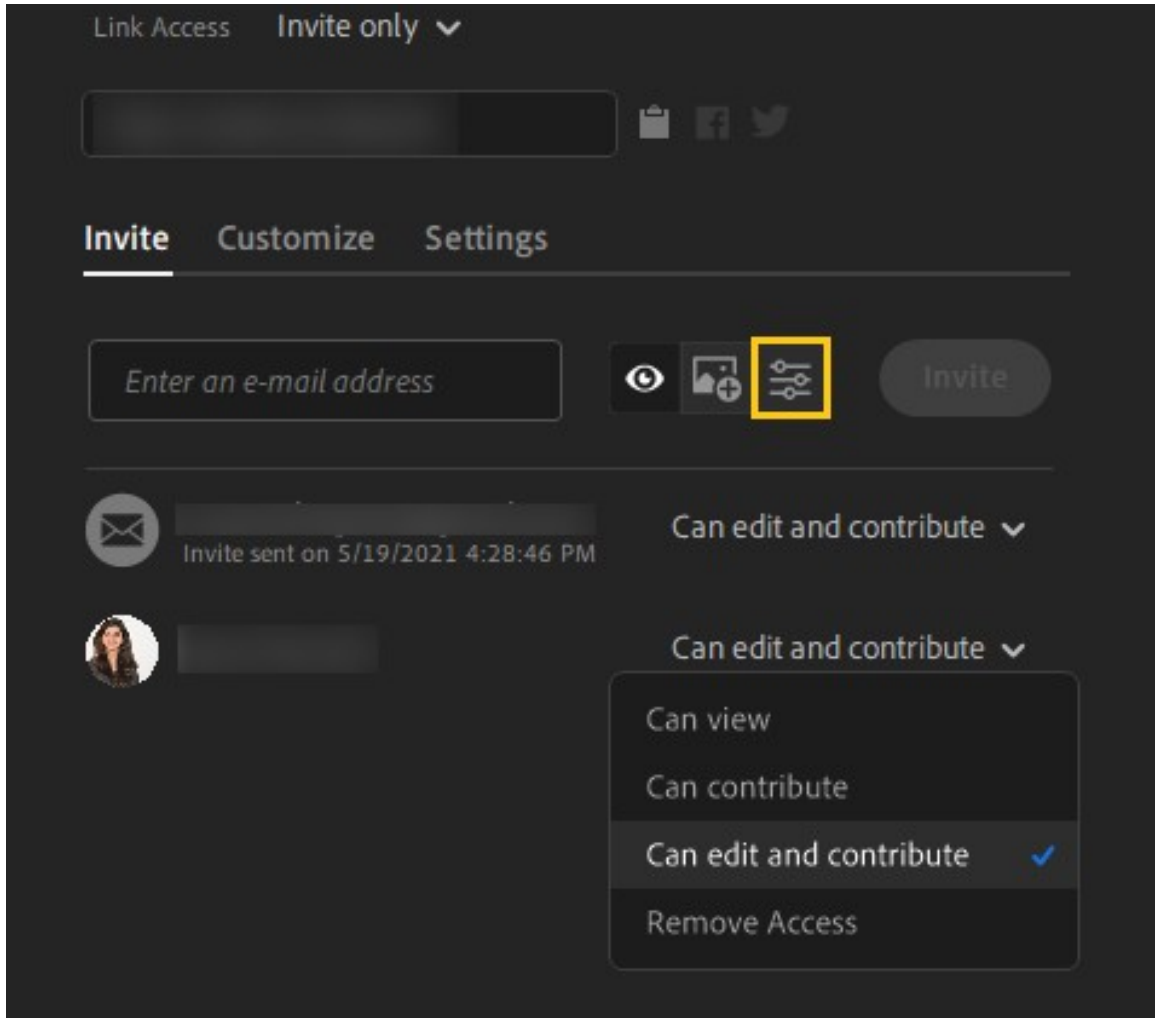
BETTER MOVE

Use a checklist and a second reviewer for high-risk or high-volume work.

Archive for Reuse and Audit

A reusable archive preserves creative value, rights evidence, and production learning.

- **Keep originals and approved derivatives**
- Retain edit history where appropriate
- Use clear version and project naming
- Apply retention and access rules



Archive for Reuse and Audit | What mastery looks like

1

Keep originals and approved derivatives

Connect the control or decision to the brief, inspect the evidence, and compare the result.

2

Retain edit history where appropriate

Connect the control or decision to the brief, inspect the evidence, and compare the result.

3

Use clear version and project naming

Connect the control or decision to the brief, inspect the evidence, and compare the result.

4

Apply retention and access rules

Connect the control or decision to the brief, inspect the evidence, and compare the result.

Archive for Reuse and Audit | Decision loop



MASTER EDITOR PRINCIPLE

“Professional editing is repeatable because its decisions can be explained and traced.”

Use this as the topic's decision rule, then prove it through the activity evidence.

ORIGINAL COURSE MAXIM

REAL-WORKPLACE PRACTICE

Activity 07 | Capstone: Northstar Retail Campaign Review and Delivery

Topic 3

Northstar Home, a Singapore lifestyle retailer, needs a six-image launch set for web, social media, and an in-store screen. Stakeholders disagree about mood, two source images have uncertain licence records, one portrait contains location metadata, and the marketing lead wants a shareable review album by 3:15 pm. You must manage the brief, editing, evaluation, collaboration, IP checks, and delivery trail.

STAKEHOLDER LENS

Work with Lead photo editor, Marketing lead, Brand designer.

EVIDENCE

Produce creative brief and rights register and six-image edited campaign set.

QUALITY GATE

Every brief, edit, rights and delivery decision is traceable.

Full click-by-click workflow, scenario, questions, evidence templates, and acceptance criteria are in the Learner Guide and activity PDF pack.

Topic 3 | Evidence of skill

PROOF OF EDITING SKILL

The brief, edit decisions, before/after evidence, quality checks, stakeholder response, rights status, and output specification tell one coherent story.

SECTION 99

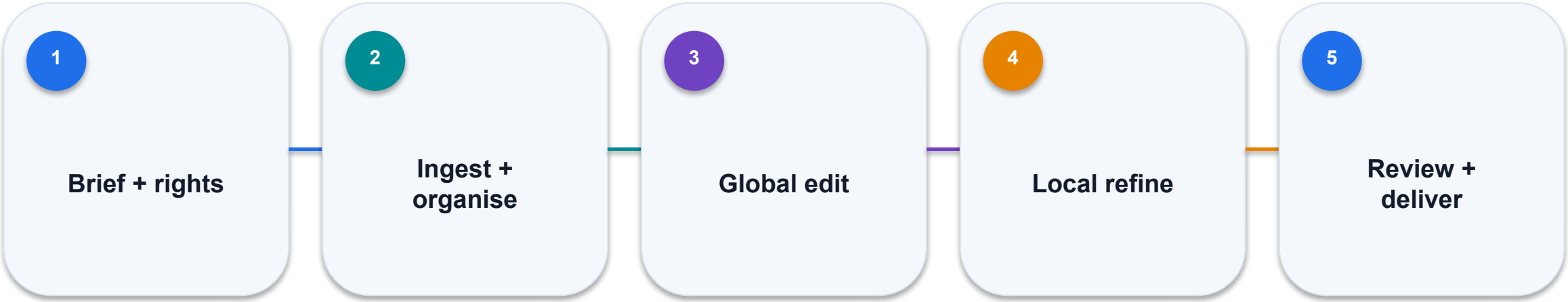
Integration

From isolated controls to a production system

Observe the image. State the intent. Make a controlled change. Verify the result.



The Lightroom Production System



What You Achieved

1

EXPLORE

Translate stakeholder intent into testable image decisions.

2

IMPROVE

Build non-destructive global and local editing techniques through deliberate practice.

3

EVALUATE

Judge Lightroom capabilities through design, technical, and authenticity evidence.

4

DELIVER

Review, export, share, and archive with rights and privacy controls.

FINAL EDITOR PRINCIPLE

“A finished image is a visible decision trail.”

When the brief, edit, evidence, rights, approval, and export agree, the work is ready to leave the studio.

ORIGINAL COURSE MAXIM

Course Feedback

1

RATE

Rate the content, activities and pace of the day.

2

SHARE

Tell us what helped most and what to improve.

3

PRACTISE

Repeat the activities with your own photographs.

4

COMPLETE

Submit the feedback form shared by your trainer.

Thank You

Edit with intention. Check the evidence. Protect the original.

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